PLATFORM UPDATE

Digital Examination Moderation System

Moderation from set paper to signed report, in one place

Presented by John Meyer

Cape Peninsula University of Technology

THE REASON

Why moderation is moving online

Before

Word and PDF files e-mailed back and forth.

No single view of what is overdue.

Hard to prove which version was approved and by whom.

Paper forms and re-typed details.

Now

One record per assessment, with every document, comment and signature on it.

Deadlines and reminders built in.

Digital signatures and a tamper-evident audit trail.

The official CPUT Appendix 2 report is produced automatically.

What this update adds

Overview dashboards for heads of department and programme.

A report for the Dean, with an AI-written discussion.

Multiple documents with versions, and comments on Word and PDF.

Install on any device.

Goal: every assessment is moderated before it is written, signed off after it is marked, and visible to the people who need to see it.

OVERVIEW

The process at a glance

1

Section 1

Examiner

Details, question weightings and the paper

2

Gate 1

Internal moderator

Reviews the paper in the browser; approves or sends back

3

Section 2

Examiner

Marks, statistics and comments

4

Gate 2

Internal moderator

Final review and signature

5

Gate 3

External moderator

Only if assigned: Section 3

6

Archive

Examiner + HOD

Sign Section 3; PDF report archived

Before the assessment

Pre-moderation (steps 1–2) is finished 14 days before the assessment date.

After the assessment

Post-moderation (steps 3–6) is finished 14 days after the assessment date.

ROLES

Who uses it, and what they see

Examiner

Sets the assessment, uploads the paper, submits marks and signs.

Internal moderator

Reviews papers and results; comments in the document; approves or sends back.

External moderator

Independent review (Section 3) once the internal moderator has signed off.

Head of Department

Sees all subjects, signs off, and reports to the Dean. Can delete practice records.

Head of Programme

Sees the progress dashboard for the qualification(s) they head. No papers or marks.

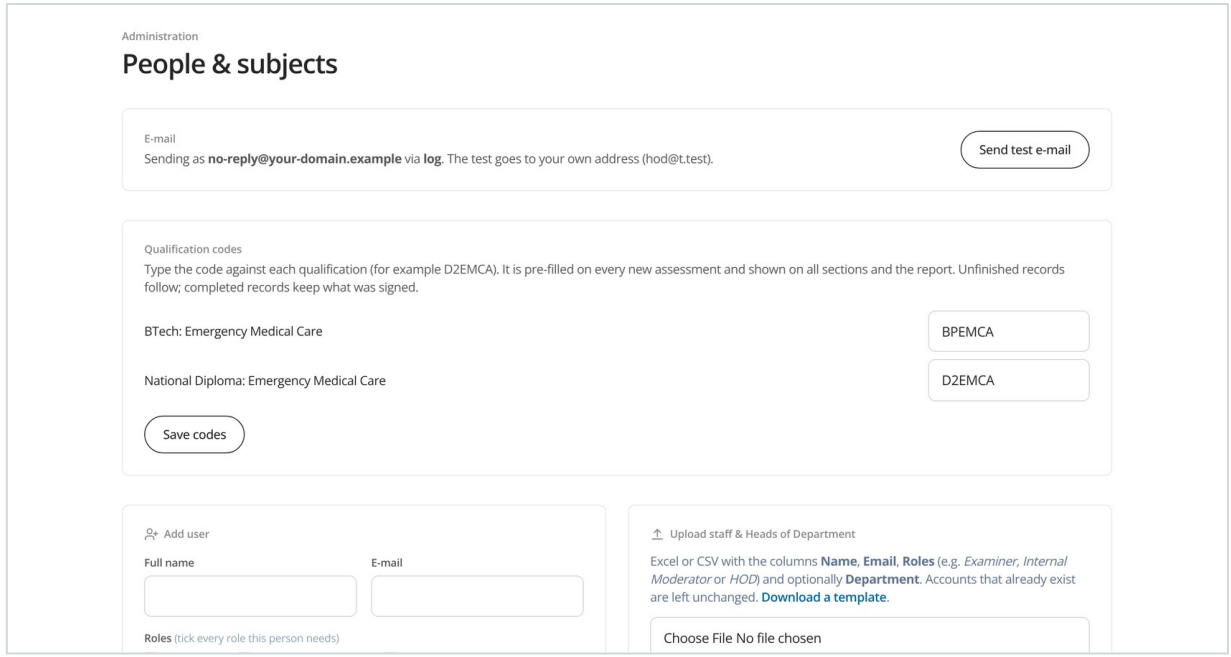
System Administrator

Runs the platform: accounts, approvals, uploads. No access to assessments or audit trails.

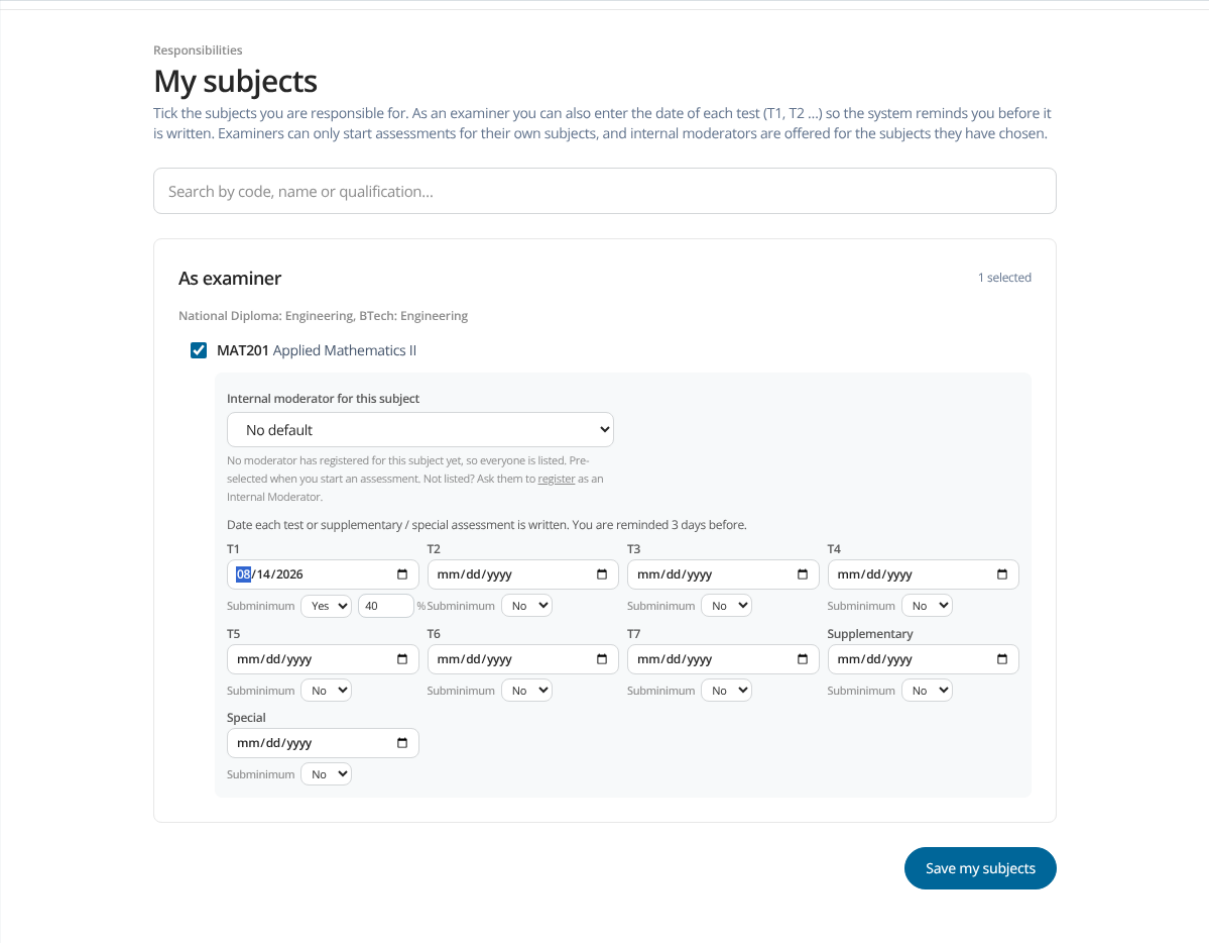
A person can hold several roles, for example Examiner and Internal Moderator.

Getting an account

- **Register** — staff choose their roles (Examiner, Moderators, Head of Programme) and wait for approval.
- **Approve** — the HOD or System Administrator checks the request and confirms the roles.
- **Upload staff** — an Excel or CSV list of names, e-mails and roles creates accounts in one go.
- **Subjects** — import the subject list (qualification, code, name); set qualification codes once.
- **Safe sign-in** — passwords of 10+ characters; each person can change theirs, or delete their account.



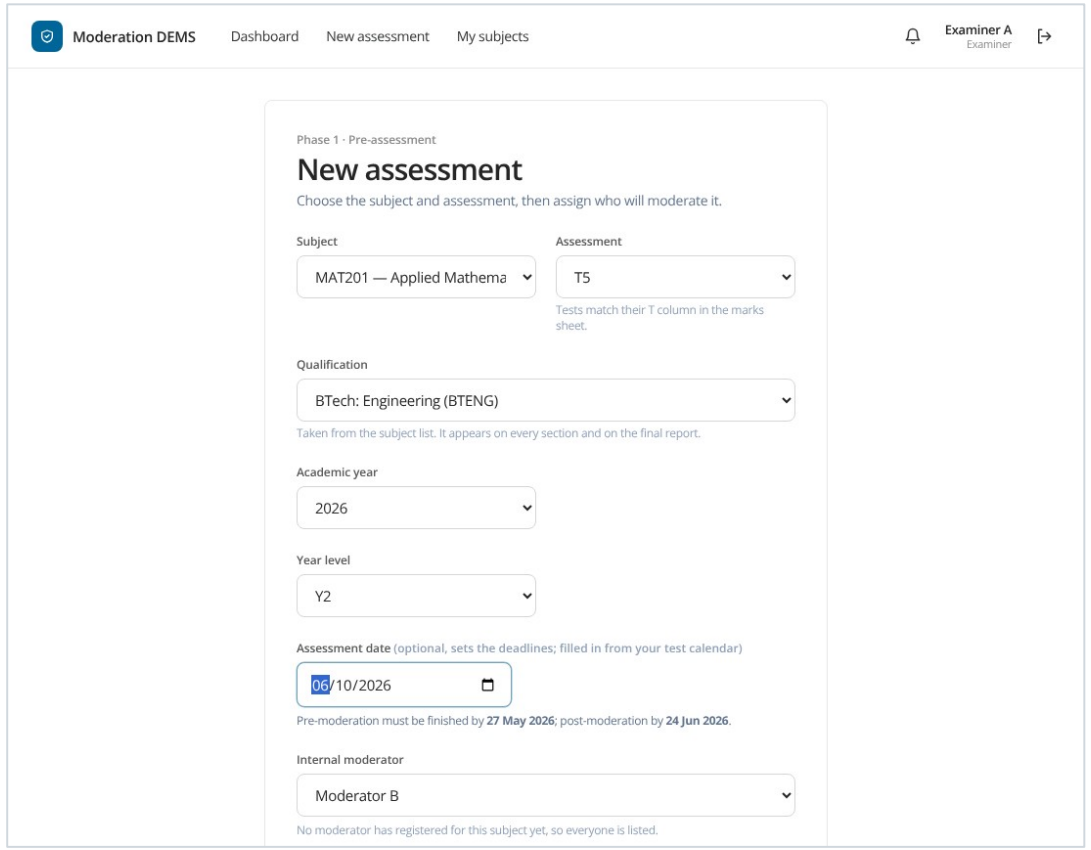
My subjects and the test calendar

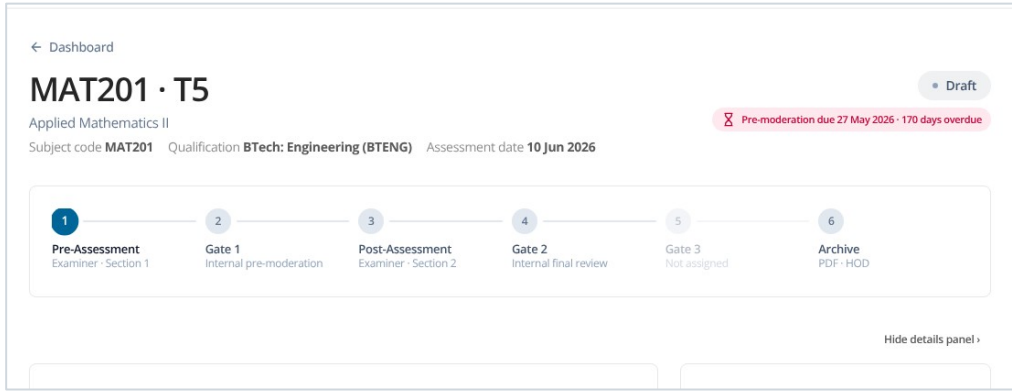


- **Pick your subjects** and your usual internal moderator.
- **Date every test** — T1 to T7, Supplementary, Special, Sick and Deferred.
- **Subminimum** — Yes or No per test, with the % the student must reach.
- **Reminders** three days before each test, and when a moderation deadline is close or missed.
- **Historic dates** are accepted, for assessments already written.

EXAMINER

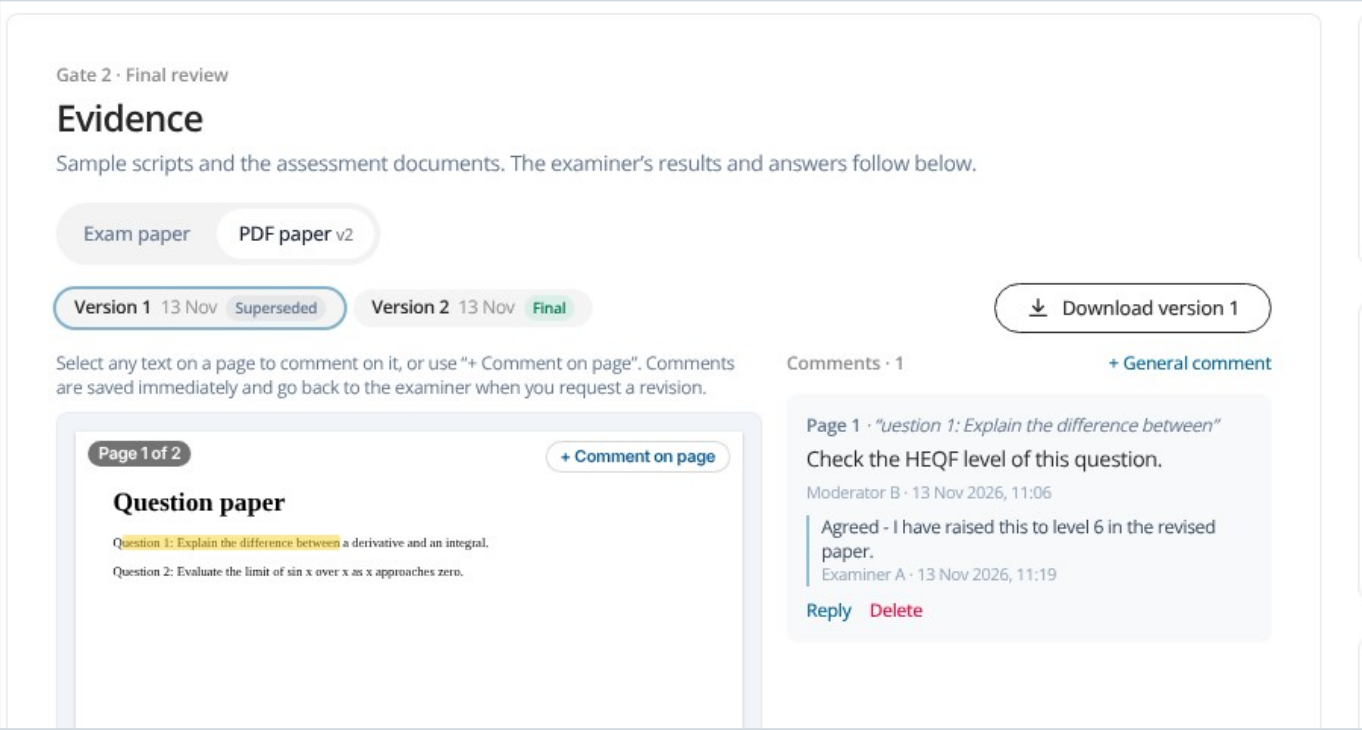
Starting an assessment: type it once





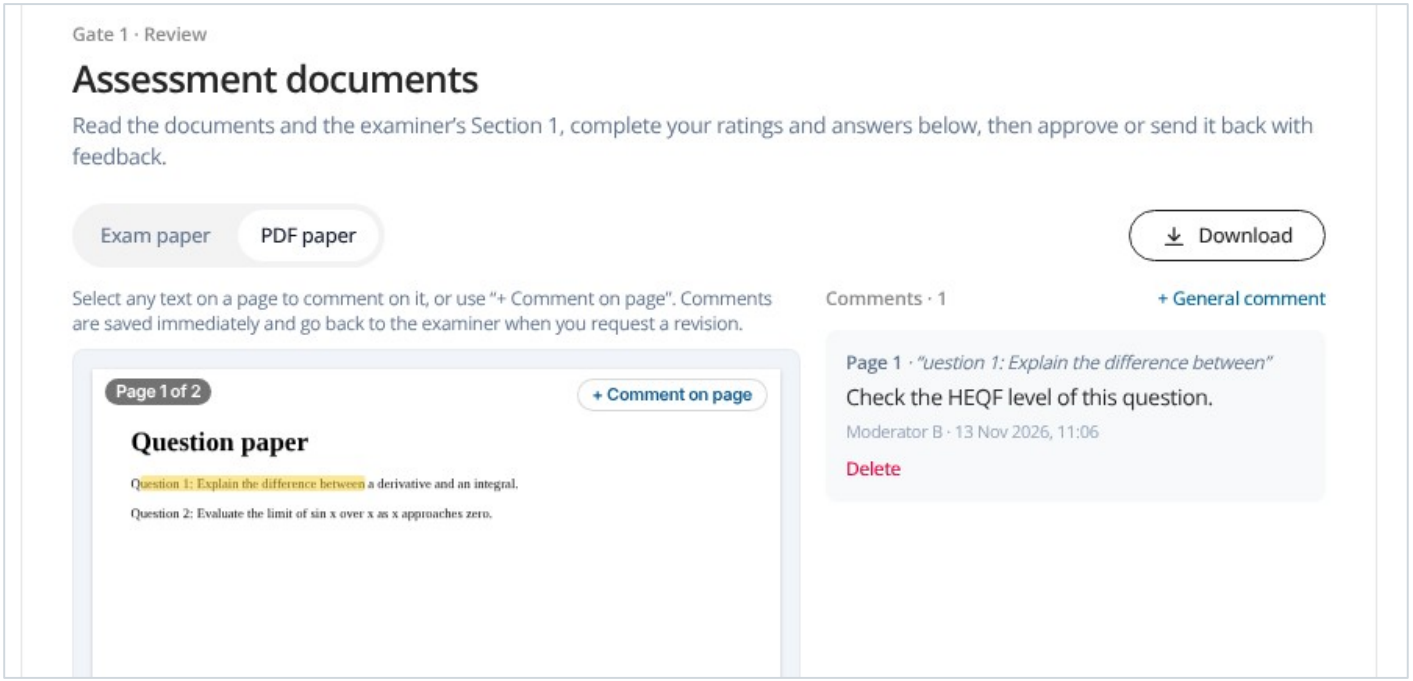
- **Subject, qualification and date** are pulled through to every section and the PDF report.
- **Qualification codes** (for example D2EMCA) are set once by the administrator.
- **Deadlines** are worked out from the date: 14 days before and after.

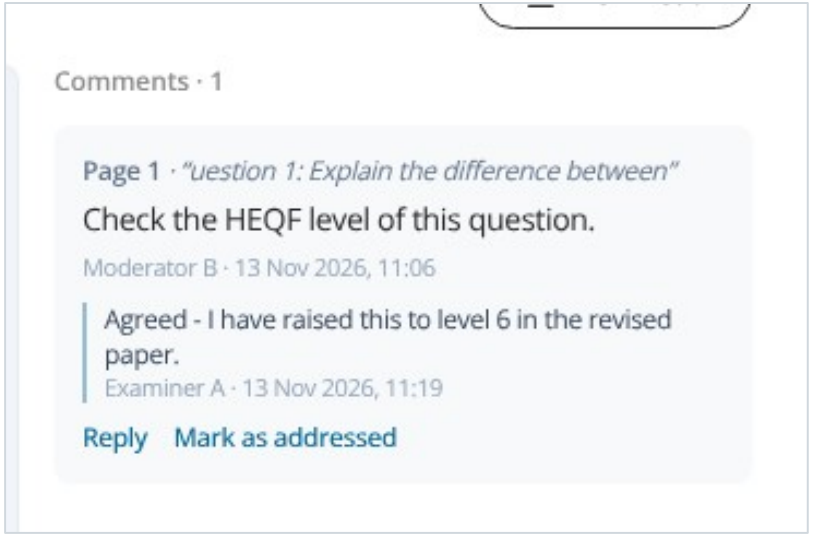
Several documents, clear versions, no separate memo



- **Upload the paper** — it already contains the memorandum.
- **Add other documents** — annexures, formula sheets, extra papers.
- **Version 2, 3 …** every revision is kept and labelled.
- **Final** marks the version that passed pre-moderation.
- **Everything is read inline** in the browser, with comments.

Comment on the document itself, and reply

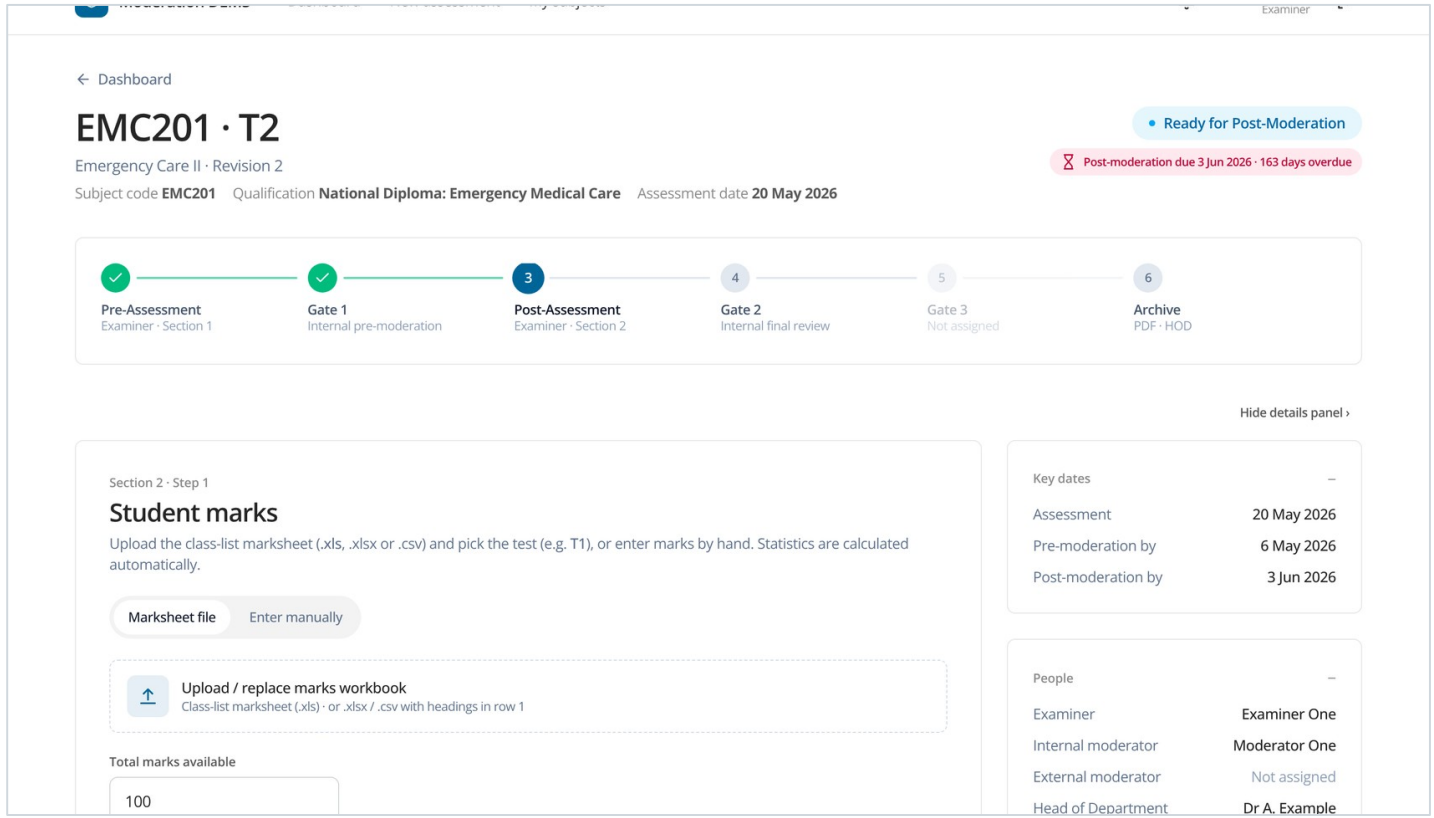




- **Select text** in Word or PDF and comment.
- **Reply** — examiner and moderator talk under each comment.
- **Mark addressed** when the change is made.

EXAMINER

Section 2: marks, results and the subminimum

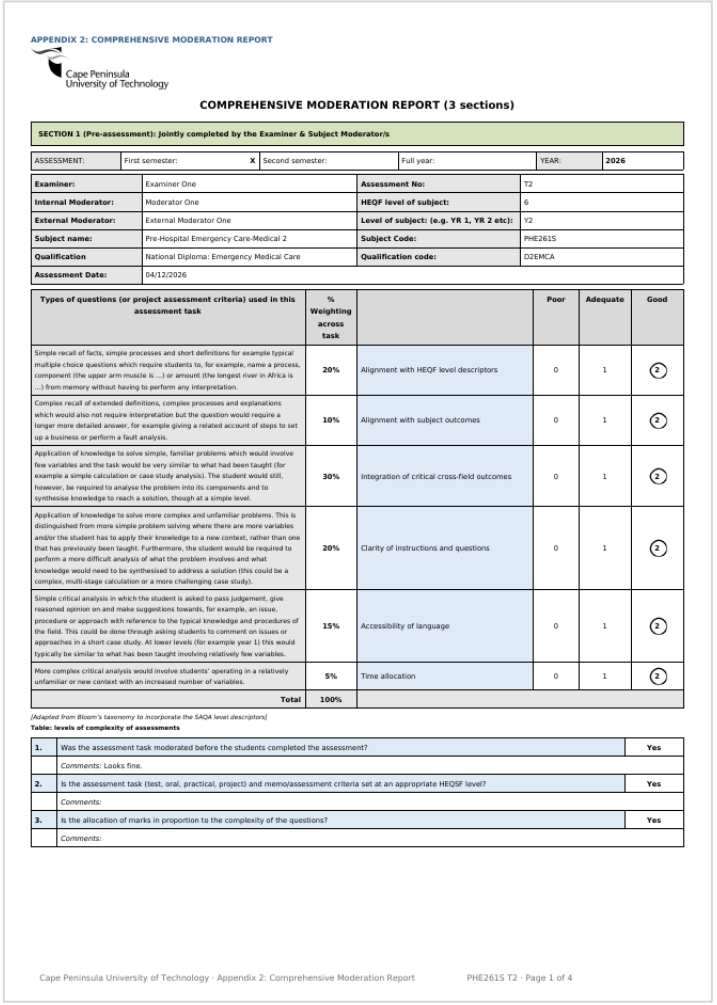


- **Marks** from the class list column that matches the test (T1…T7, Supplementary, Special, Sick, Deferred).
- **Statistics** — pass rate, average, highest, lowest, distribution.
- **Subminimum** — how many met it, how many passed or failed.
- **No student data** leaves the system; marks are anonymous numbers.

APPENDIX 2

Signed and sealed: the official CPUT report

- **Digital signatures** — drawn and confirmed with the signer's password.
- **Audit trail** — hash-chained: any change to the history is detectable.
- **Official form** — Appendix 2: Comprehensive Moderation Report, produced as a PDF.
- **Pass and fail figures** and the subminimum sit under the "general adjustments of the marks" question.
- **The record can be deleted** by the HOD only if it was a demo or practice run, with a password and a typed confirmation.



APPENDIX 2: COMPREHENSIVE MODERATION REPORT

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COMPREHENSIVE MODERATION REPORT (3 sections)

SECTION 1 (Pre-assessment): Jointly completed by the Examiner & Subject Moderator/s

ASSESSMENT:	First semester:	x	Second semester:	Full year:	YEAR:	2026

Examiner:	Examiner One	**Assessment No:**	T2
Internal Moderator:	Moderator One	**HEQF level of subject:**	6
External Moderator:	External Moderator One	**Level of subject: (e.g. YR 1, YR 2 etc):**	Y2
Subject name:	Pre-Hospital Emergency Care-Medical 2	**Subject Code:**	PHE261S
Qualification	National Diploma: Emergency Medical Care	**Qualification code:**	D2EMCA
Assessment Date:	04/12/2026		

Types of questions (or project assessment criteria) used in this assessment task	% Weighting across task		Poor	Adequate	Good
Simple recall of facts, simple processes and short definitions for example typical multiple choice questions which require students to, for example, name a process, component (the upper arm muscle is ...) or amount (the longest river in Africa is ...) from memory without having to perform any interpretation.	20%	Alignment with HEQF level descriptors	0	1	2
Complex recall of extended definitions, complex processes and explanations which would also not require interpretation but the question would require a longer more detailed answer, for example giving a related account of steps to set up a business or perform a fault analysis.	10%	Alignment with subject outcomes	0	1	2
Application of knowledge to solve simple, familiar problems which would involve few variables and the task would be very similar to what had been taught (for example a simple calculation or case study analysis). The student would still, however, be required to analyse the problem into its components and to synthesise knowledge to reach a solution, though at a simple level.	30%	Integration of critical cross-field outcomes	0	1	2
Application of knowledge to solve more complex and unfamiliar problems. This is distinguished from more simple problem solving where there are more variables and/or the student has to apply their knowledge to a new context, rather than one that has previously been taught. Furthermore, the student would be required to perform a more difficult analysis of what the problem involves and what knowledge would need to be synthesised to address a solution (this could be a complex, multi-stage calculation or a more challenging case study).	20%	Clarity of instructions and questions	0	1	2
Simple critical analysis in which the student is asked to pass judgement, give reasoned opinion on and make suggestions towards, for example, an issue, procedure or approach with reference to the typical knowledge and procedures of the field. This could be done through asking students to comment on issues or approaches in a short case study. At lower levels (for example year 1) this would typically be similar to what has been taught involving relatively few variables.	15%	Accessibility of language	0	1	2
More complex critical analysis would involve students' operating in a relatively unfamiliar or new context with an increased number of variables.	5%	Time allocation	0	1	2
Total	**100%**				

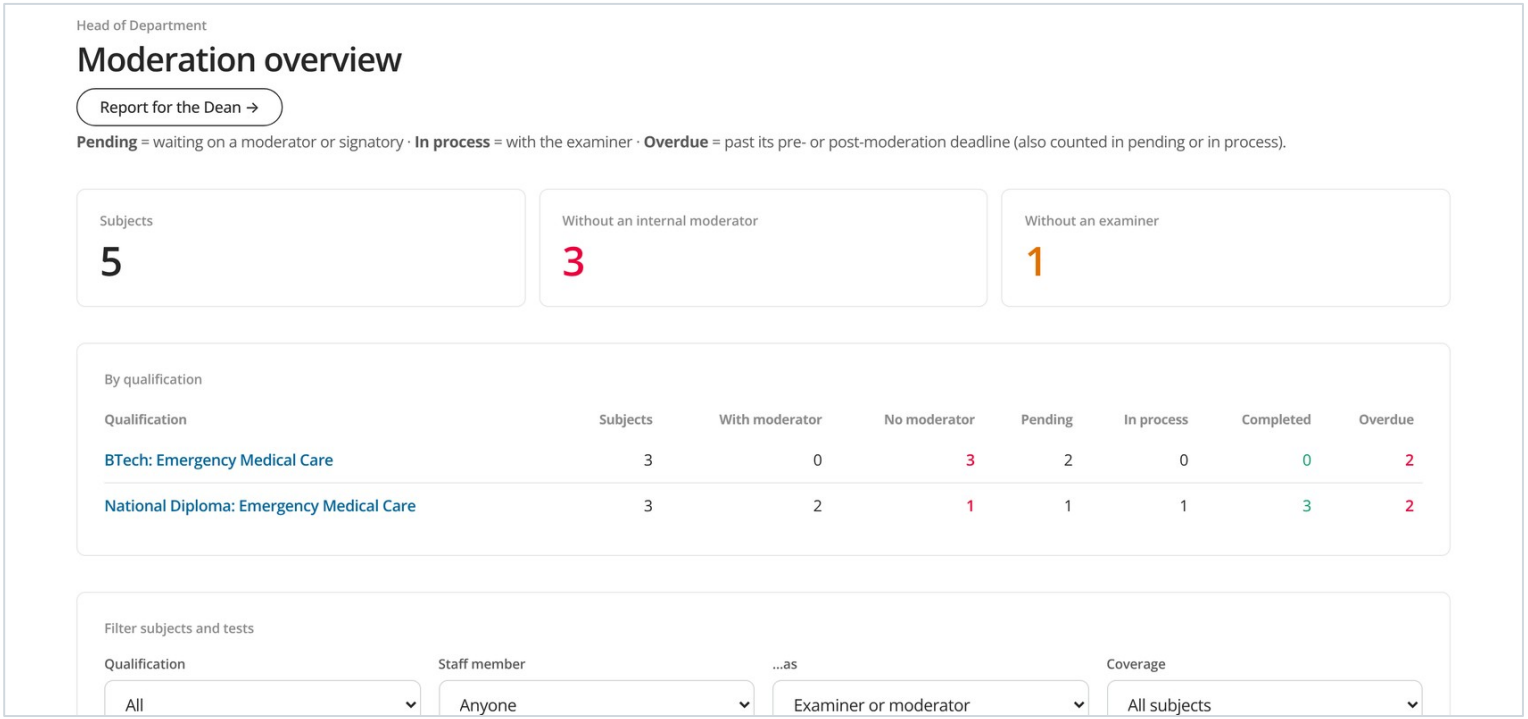
[Adapted from Bloom's taxonomy to incorporate the SAQA level descriptors]

Table: levels of complexity of assessments

1.	Was the assessment task moderated before the students completed the assessment?	Yes
	Comments: Looks fine.	
2.	Is the assessment task (test, oral, practical, project) and memo/assessment criteria set at an appropriate HEQSF level?	Yes
	Comments:	
3.	Is the allocation of marks in proportion to the complexity of the questions?	Yes
	Comments:	

Cape Peninsula University of Technology · Appendix 2: Comprehensive Moderation Report PHE261S T2 · Page 1 of 4

The overview: every qualification and subject

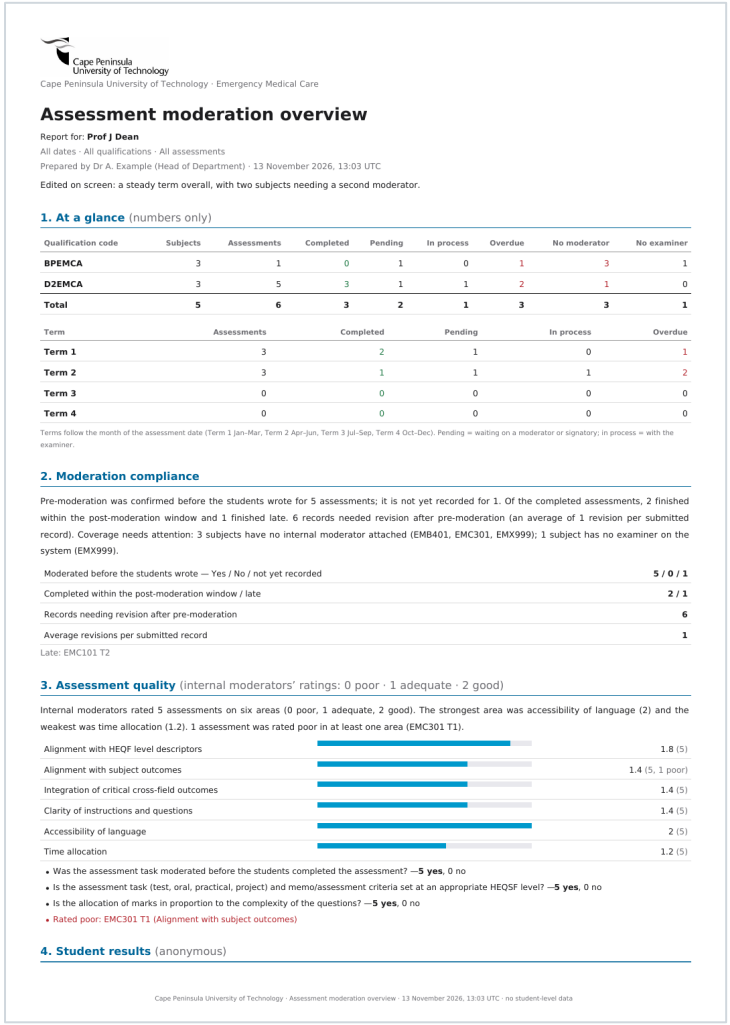


- **By qualification** — pending, in process, completed, overdue.
- **Drill down** from qualification to subject.
- **Coverage** — subjects without an internal moderator or examiner.
- **Filter** by staff member (examiner or moderator) and by date.
- **Head of Programme** sees only this view, for their own qualification(s).

HEAD OF DEPARTMENT

The report for the Dean

- **At a glance** — numbers only, one line per qualification code, plus Term 1 to 4.
- **Compliance** — moderated before the test, on time, revisions.
- **Quality** — the moderators' ratings on six areas.
- **Results** — pass rates by qualification, term and year level; falls and low rates.
- **Matters for attention** — mark adjustments, overdue items, subjects without moderators.
- **Appendix** — every assessment, in four terms. PDF or Word, any time.



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Assessment moderation overview

Report for: **Prof J Dean**

All dates · All qualifications · All assessments

Prepared by Dr A. Example (Head of Department) · 13 November 2026, 13:03 UTC

Edited on screen: a steady term overall, with two subjects needing a second moderator.

1. At a glance (numbers only)

Qualification code	Subjects	Assessments	Completed	Pending	In process	Overdue	No moderator	No examiner
BPEMCA	3	1	0	1	0	1	3	1
D2EMCA	3	5	3	1	1	2	1	0
Total	**5**	**6**	**3**	**2**	**1**	**3**	**3**	**1**

Term	Assessments	Completed	Pending	In process	Overdue
Term 1	3	2	1	0	1
Term 2	3	1	1	1	2
Term 3	0	0	0	0	0
Term 4	0	0	0	0	0

Terms follow the month of the assessment date (Term 1 Jan-Mar, Term 2 Apr-Jun, Term 3 Jul-Sep, Term 4 Oct-Dec). Pending = waiting on a moderator or signatory; in process = with the examiner.

2. Moderation compliance

Pre-moderation was confirmed before the students wrote for 5 assessments; it is not yet recorded for 1. Of the completed assessments, 2 finished within the post-moderation window and 1 finished late. 6 records needed revision after pre-moderation (an average of 1 revision per submitted record). Coverage needs attention: 3 subjects have no internal moderator attached (EMB401, EMC301, EMX999); 1 subject has no examiner on the system (EMX999).

Moderated before the students wrote — Yes / No / not yet recorded	**5 / 0 / 1**
Completed within the post-moderation window / late	**2 / 1**
Records needing revision after pre-moderation	**6**
Average revisions per submitted record	**1**

Late: EMC101 T2

3. Assessment quality (internal moderators' ratings: 0 poor · 1 adequate · 2 good)

Internal moderators rated 5 assessments on six areas (0 poor, 1 adequate, 2 good). The strongest area was accessibility of language (2) and the weakest was time allocation (1.2). 1 assessment was rated poor in at least one area (EMC301 T1).

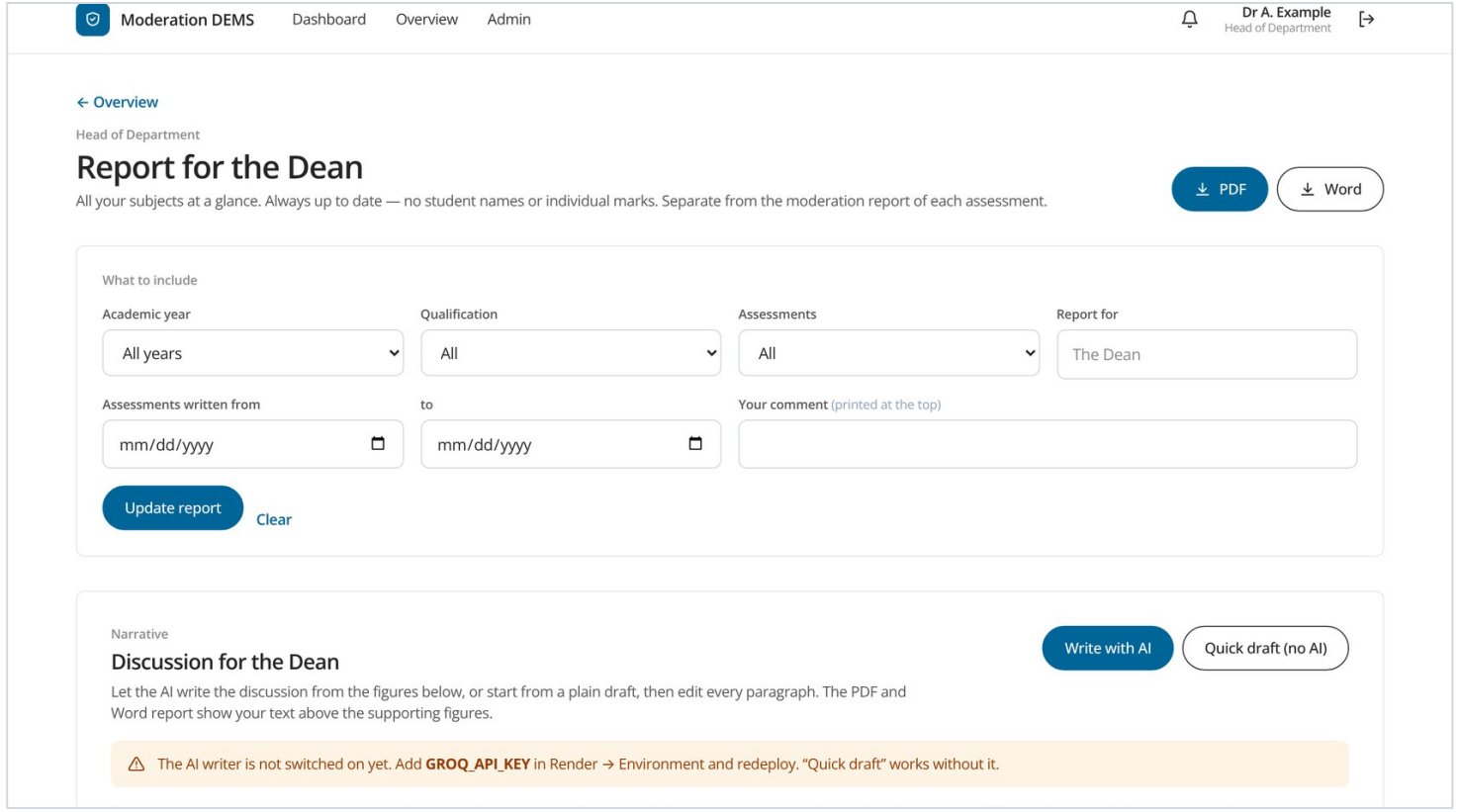
Alignment with HEQF level descriptors	1.8 (5)
Alignment with subject outcomes	1.4 (5, 1 poor)
Integration of critical cross-field outcomes	1.4 (5)
Clarity of instructions and questions	1.4 (5)
Accessibility of language	2 (5)
Time allocation	1.2 (5)

- Was the assessment task moderated before the students completed the assessment? —**5 yes**, 0 no
- Is the assessment task (test, oral, practical, project) and memo/assessment criteria set at an appropriate HEQSF level? —**5 yes**, 0 no
- Is the allocation of marks in proportion to the complexity of the questions? —**5 yes**, 0 no
- Rated poor: EMC301 T1 (Alignment with subject outcomes)

4. Student results (anonymous)

Cape Peninsula University of Technology · Assessment moderation overview · 13 November 2026, 13:03 UTC · no student-level data

The discussion for the Dean: written with AI



- **Write with AI** — six paragraphs from the figures, in plain formal English.
- **Quick draft** — the same, without AI.
- **You edit** every paragraph; the PDF and Word include exactly what is on screen.
- **Privacy** — no student data, no staff names, e-mail addresses removed.

TRUST

Safe by design

Right people, right records

Examiners and moderators see only their assessments; the external moderator only after sign-off; the Head of Programme only a dashboard.

Signed and traceable

Signatures need the signer’s password; the audit trail is hash-chained and cannot be edited quietly.

Anonymous marks

Raw marks are numbers only; the class list stays with the examiner.

Controlled changes

Deleting a record needs the HOD’s password and a typed confirmation, and is logged.

Data stays put

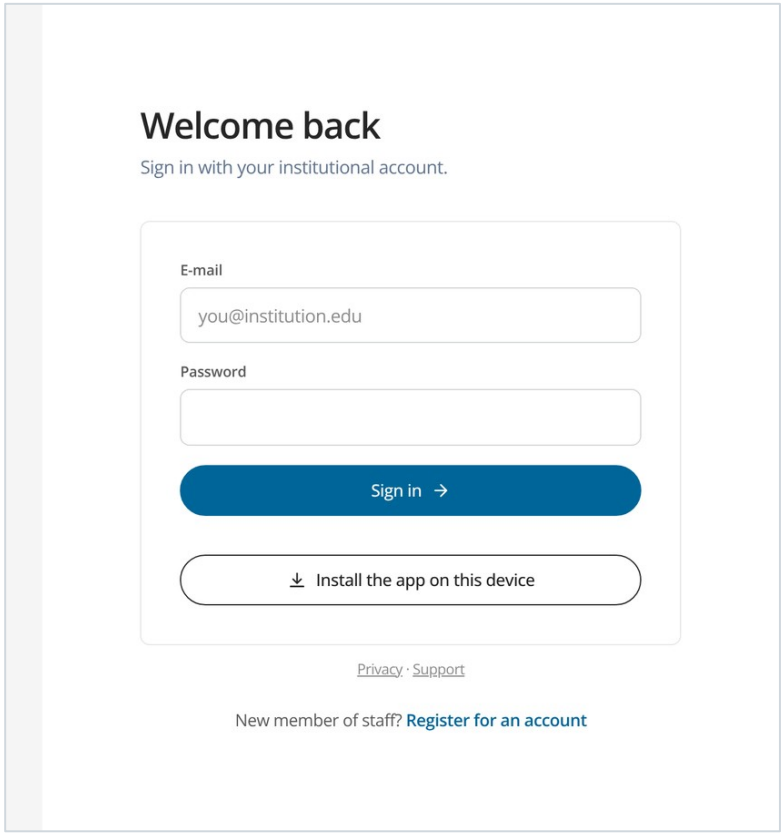
Hosted with a managed database; row-level security is on; secrets are kept out of the code.

AI with limits

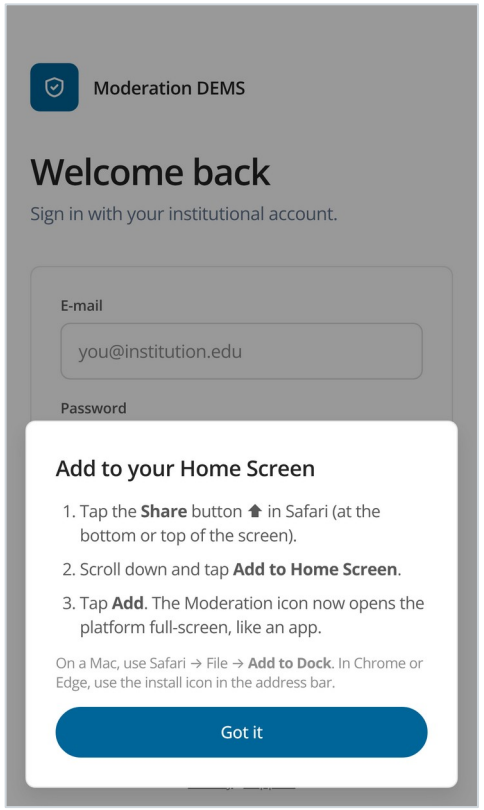
Only summary figures and subject codes are sent; the HOD edits the text before it is used.

ACCESS

Works on any device, and installs like an app



Chrome, Edge, Android



iPhone and iPad

- **Install app** button on the sign-in page, the top bar and the account page.
- **iPhone and iPad** — Share, then Add to Home Screen.
- **Full-screen** with a home-screen icon and quick links.
- **Phone friendly** — every screen works on a phone.
- **App Store app** — prepared; waiting for CPUT's Apple account.

ROADMAP

Where we are, and what comes next

Live today

Full moderation workflow

Multiple documents and versions

Inline comments, Word and PDF

Overview and Dean report

AI-written discussion (needs the Groq key)

Installable in the browser

E-mail reminders (need mail set-up)

Next

Apple developer account and Mac build for the iPhone app

Push notifications and Face ID in the app

Final privacy wording

Mail from a CPUT address for reminders

Planned, not built

AI check of the paper against the question-weighting table

A replacement test linked to the original for supplementary, sick and deferred cases

NEXT STEPS

What I need from you

- **Confirm the HODs and Heads of Programme** so their roles and qualifications can be set up.
- **Check the qualification codes** for each qualification.
- **Choose a pilot group** of examiners and moderators for one term.
- **Provide the CPUT mailbox** (or an approved mail service) so reminders go out by e-mail.
- **Apple account details** from the person who holds CPUT's developer account.

Questions?

John Meyer

Moderation platform · Cape Peninsula University of Technology

Thank you.